ARKAD'S LEDGER

Day 3 Production Package

Publishing date: Sunday 11 October 2026 (US Eastern) · Myanmar: Sun 11 Oct, 6:00 PM → Mon 12 Oct, 8:00 AM

Prepared 10 Oct 2026 · 5 videos · YouTube Shorts · TikTok · Facebook Reels · This package itself does not post or schedule anything

Final deliverables: finished videos in videos/ (v1–v5, 1080×1920, 30 fps, H.264/AAC, about −16 LUFS), covers in thumbnails/ (PNG master + JPG under 2 MB each, contact-sheet.png, contact-sheet-safezones.png), upload sheets in upload/v1–v5.txt. Upload copies of every MP4 and JPG plus metadata.json are in /workspace/arkads-upload/2026-10-11/. Scripts below match the final audio word for word.

1. Day 3 Run Sheet

#	Role	ET (Sun 11 Oct)	Myanmar (Asia/Yangon)	UTC	Final title	Pillar	Format · Series	Words	Final length (ffprobe)
1	Commute explainer	7:30 AM	Sun 11 Oct, 6:00 PM	11:30	Why a Stock Price Can Fall With No News	P5 Markets & Investing Mechanics	F8 Simulated Crowd · *The Money Machine · Ep. 3*	245	**93.2 s**
2	Everyday lunch topic (verified numbers)	12:00 PM	Sun 11 Oct, 10:30 PM	16:00	Where Your Lunch Dollar Really Goes	P3 Everyday Economics & Pricing Psychology	F3 The Receipt · *What You're Really Paying For · Ep. 1*	202	**82.9 s**
3	How a well-known company makes money (reveal)	4:00 PM	Mon 12 Oct, 2:30 AM	20:00	How McDonald's Really Makes Its Money	P8 Business Models & Corporate Economics	F14 One Number · *Follow the Money · Ep. 3*	229	**95.5 s**
4	Flagship: longest, story arc, CTA	7:00 PM	Mon 12 Oct, 5:30 AM	23:00	1929: The Crash Was Only Act One. Then Came the Bank Runs	P10 Crises, Bubbles & Economic History	F9 Timeline Rewind · *Collapse Files · No. 002*	390	**158.3 s**
5	Calm formula	9:30 PM	Mon 12 Oct, 8:00 AM	01:30 (12 Oct)	Why Early Mortgage Payments Are Mostly Interest	P4 Debt, Credit & Interest	F5 Build-a-Formula · *Ledger Formulas · Ep. 3*	219	**85.6 s**

Cross-posting per slot: TikTok at the slot time → YouTube Shorts +10 min → Facebook Reels +20 min (exact times in each upload sheet). **Do NOT mark any video as AI-generated** (TikTok AI label off; YouTube altered/synthetic content: No; no AI label on Facebook). Every description/caption carries "Educational content, not financial advice."

Daylight saving: US clocks fall back on **Sunday 1 November 2026**. ET slot times stay fixed (7:30 AM, 12:00 PM, 4:00 PM, 7:00 PM, 9:30 PM ET); from that date every Myanmar time moves **one hour later** (ET + 11 h 30 min instead of + 10 h 30 min), e.g. slot 1 becomes 7:00 PM MMT.

Timing method: each narration is ONE continuous edge-tts take (en-US-AndrewNeural, rate −5%), timed from its word-boundary events, with short silences inserted between beats at exact word boundaries. Lengths are ffprobe durations of the final MP4s and include the ~3 s branded end card. All five run 82.9–158.3 s (rule: ≥61 s and <180 s). Every hook starts at about 0.4 s with its key visual on screen from frame 0.

2. Day 3 plan notes & rotation

- **Mix:** all five topics are evergreen (no current-events slot today). International angle: McDonald's operates in 100+ countries, and V4 shows the 1930s deflation spreading abroad through the gold standard.
- **Video 1** uses the stock-price / order-book script archived on Day 2 (production/future/stock-price-order-book/), now verified and produced as *The Money Machine · Ep. 3*.
- **Video 3** follows the owner's brief (how a well-known company makes money, building to a reveal; not Costco). P8 therefore sits in slot 3 for the third day running, which the strategy's pillar-rotation rule would normally avoid.
- **Video 4 (flagship)** is the longest of the day at 158.3 s, a little over the ~150 s preference but well under 180 s; it ends with a call to action and a branded end card.
- **Video 5** puts the formula on screen first (INTEREST = BALANCE × RATE ÷ 12) and then works one example.
- **Cooldowns:** no mechanism repeats Day 1–2 (bank money creation, left-digit bias, co-brand loyalty, hyperinflation, compounding, tax brackets, shrinkflation, membership model, dollar dominance, economies of scale). New stories/mechanisms: order book, USDA food dollar, franchise rent model, 1930s bank runs/deposit insurance, amortization.

3. Global specs & QA method

Item	Spec
Export	1080×1920, 9:16, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC; integrated loudness about −16 LUFS, true peak about −2 dBFS
Narration	One continuous take per video, en-US-AndrewNeural at −5%; pitch/pace check (voice_qa) for drone, flat, rushed or low passages; flagged lines rephrased and regenerated
Captions	Burned-in, word-timed, key word in gold, inside the lower-middle safe area
Sources on screen	Small source tag whenever a sourced figure appears; EXAMPLE / ILLUSTRATION / SHAPE SIMPLIFIED tags on hypothetical or simplified visuals
QA per video	ffprobe (size, fps, duration); contact sheet every 4 s with low-content detection plus spot frames at every scene change; EBU R128 loudness; voice_qa; speech recognition (faster-whisper small.en) on the take and on the final MP4, with any dropped words re-checked on a short clip
AI label	Do NOT mark as AI-generated on any platform (owner's instruction)
Disclaimer	"Educational content, not financial advice." in every YouTube description, TikTok caption/pinned comment and Facebook caption

Pre-publish checklist

- ☐ All five MP4s measured ≥ 61 s and < 180 s (82.9–158.3 s ✓)
- ☐ Signed-in account is Arkad's Ledger on every platform (YouTube @arkadsledger, TikTok @arkadsledger, Facebook Page Arkad's Ledger) – never ShakaHub or A Bit Inside
- ☐ Custom cover set on each platform from thumbnails/
- ☐ Titles, captions, hashtags and source comments pasted from upload/vN.txt (or metadata.json)
- ☐ AI-generated label OFF on every platform
- ☐ Myanmar = ET + 10 h 30 min while the US is on EDT (until 1 Nov 2026)

Style for every scene: 9:16 1080×1920, deep-navy background with soft vignette and slow gold dust, flat vector icons in ivory/gold (coral for losses/interest), Montserrat-style bold sans text, key content kept inside x 100–980 / y 420–1200, word-timed captions at the lower middle, small source tag above the captions.

4. Video 1: Why a Stock Price Can Fall With No News

Field	Detail
Slot	1 · Commute explainer · **7:30 AM ET** · **Sun 11 Oct, 6:00 PM MMT** · 11:30 UTC
Pillar / format / series	P5 Markets & Investing Mechanics · F8 Simulated Crowd · *The Money Machine · Ep. 3*
Final length	**93.2 s** (245 words; narration 0.4–89.8 s, then the end card)
Video file	videos/v1-stock-price-no-news.mp4
Thumbnail	thumbnails/v1-stock-price-no-news.jpg · "PRICE FELL / NO NEWS"
Visual plan	Blank newspaper and a falling ticker at frame 0; order book with bids/asks (EXAMPLE prices $96–$103); a big fund sells through $99, $98, $97 and LAST TRADE ticks down; crowds of buyers and sellers react; 1989 study card ("≈ 1/3 of swings explained by news"); payoff with the two crowds meeting at the price.
QA notes	voice_qa: no DRONE/FLAT/RUSH/LOW flags (archived take, re-verified) · −16.1 LUFS, peak −2.0 dBFS, LRA 3.1 · frame sheet reviewed: order book moved down so it no longer overlaps chips/source tag, LAST TRADE moved lower, crowds enlarged and centred, fund chip relabelled EXAMPLE · ASR on final MP4 99.6% word match (only number formatting).

1.1 Narration script with timestamps

Beat	Time	Narration (exact voice text)	Words
hook	0:00.4–0:05.6	No headline. No announcement. And the share price still fell. So who moved the price?	15
setup	0:06.5–0:15.7	A stock price isn't set by the company. It's simply the price of the last trade between a buyer and a seller. To see why it moves, open the order book.	31
dev1	0:16.7–0:32.9	On one side, buyers post bids: the most they'll pay. On the other, sellers post asks: the least they'll accept. In this example, the best bid is ninety-nine dollars and the best ask is one hundred. Nothing trades until someone crosses that gap.	43
dev2	0:33.9–0:51.7	Now a big fund decides to sell, maybe just to raise cash. First, it sells to every buyer waiting at ninety-nine. Then ninety-eight. Then ninety-seven. Each trade prints a lower price. And yet, nothing about the company had changed. The buyers at the top simply ran out.	47
dev3	0:52.7–1:00.3	Then the crowd reacts, and some sellers lower their asks to get out first. Expectations shift, with or without a headline.	21
evidence	1:01.3–1:14.7	A study published in nineteen eighty-nine found it hard to explain more than about a third of the US market's swings with economic news. And many of the biggest daily moves came on days with no identifiable major news.	39
reveal	1:15.8–1:23.8	So a price isn't a verdict on a company. It's where the most eager buyer meets the most eager seller, and that point moves whenever the crowd does.	28
payoff	1:24.8–1:29.8	A price doesn't need a headline. It only needs one side of the crowd to be in more of a hurry.	21

1.2 Scene-by-scene animation prompts

Scene	Time	Animation prompt
1 · hook	0:00.4–0:05.6	Frame 0: an empty newspaper headline area ("NO HEADLINE") beside a coral price line that tips downward; a question mark appears over the price.

Scene	Time	Animation prompt
2 · setup	0:06.5–0:15.7	A price tag labelled LAST TRADE sits between one buyer icon and one seller icon; a small handshake spark shows the trade that sets the price.
3 · dev1	0:16.7–0:32.9	An order book slides in: gold bid rows on the left, ivory ask rows on the right; the best bid ($99) and best ask ($100) glow, with the gap between them highlighted. EXAMPLE tag.
4 · dev2	0:33.9–0:51.7	A large "EXAMPLE: A BIG FUND SELLS" block hits the bid side; rows $99, $98, $97 are eaten one by one and LAST TRADE ticks down with each hit.
5 · dev3	0:52.7–1:00.3	The company card stays unchanged (calm checkmark) while the empty bid rows flash; caption "THE BUYERS AT THE TOP RAN OUT".
6 · evidence	1:01.3–1:14.7	Two crowds of small figures: sellers rush toward the exit while asks step lower; arrows show expectations shifting.
7 · reveal	1:15.8–1:23.8	A study card appears: "CUTLER, POTERBA & SUMMERS · 1989", a ring filling to about one third labelled "EXPLAINED BY NEWS", then a calendar of big-move days with no headline.
8 · payoff	1:24.8–1:29.8	The two crowds meet at a single glowing price point that slides as one crowd hurries; closing line "A PRICE ONLY NEEDS ONE SIDE IN MORE OF A HURRY".
End card	1:29.8–1:33.2	Arkad's Ledger logo and wordmark on navy with a soft gold glow; sound-out.

1.3 Platform metadata

Platform	Text
YouTube Shorts	**Title:** Why Can a Stock Price Fall When There's No News? The Order Book Explained (73 chars). **Description:** A share price isn't set by the company. It's the price of the last trade between a buyer and a seller. Open the order book and you can watch a price fall without any headline: one big seller works through the waiting buyers at $99, then $98, then $97, and each trade prints a lower price. The prices in the video are an example. ¶ A 1989 study (Cutler, Poterba & Summers, "What Moves Stock Prices?") found it hard to explain more than about a third of US market swings with economic news, and many of the biggest daily moves came on days with no identifiable major news. ¶ Sources: Cutler, Poterba & Summers, Journal of Portfolio Management, Spring 1989 (NBER working paper 2538): https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w2538/w2538.pdf · Investor.gov glossary, "Bid price" / "Ask price": https://www.investor.gov/introduction-investing/investing-basics/glossary/bid-price ¶ Educational content, not financial advice. The order-book prices are illustrative examples. **Hashtags:** #economics #stockmarket #money
TikTok	**Caption:** The share price fell. There was no news. So who moved it? 📉 Open the order book: one big seller can walk the price down, one trade at a time. Example prices. Educational content, not financial advice. (Sources pinned) #economics #stockmarket #learnontiktok #investing101 #moneytok · **Pinned comment:** Sources: Cutler, Poterba & Summers, "What Moves Stock Prices?" (Journal of Portfolio Management, 1989; NBER w2538); Investor.gov glossary (bid/ask). Order-book prices in the video are illustrative. Educational content, not financial advice.
Facebook Reels	**Caption:** Ever seen a stock drop on a day with no news at all? A price isn't a verdict on a company. It's simply where the most eager buyer meets the most eager seller. Here's how a single big sale can push the price down through the order book, step by step, using example prices. Educational content, not financial advice. (Sources in the first comment.) #economics #stockmarket · **First comment:** Sources: https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w2538/w2538.pdf (Cutler, Poterba & Summers, 1989) · https://www.investor.gov/introduction-investing/investing-basics/glossary/bid-price

1.4 Verified sources (every figure used)

Figure / claim	What it measures	Date	Source	Link
Macro/economic news explains at most about one third of return variance; many of the largest daily moves came on days without identifiable major news	US aggregate stock returns	Journal of Portfolio Management, Spring 1989 (NBER w2538, 1988)	Cutler, Poterba & Summers, "What Moves Stock Prices?"	https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w2538/w2538.pdf
Bid = highest price a buyer will pay; ask = lowest price a seller will accept	Definitions	current	Investor.gov (US SEC) glossary	https://www.investor.gov/introduction-investing/investing-basics/glossary/bid-price
Order-book prices $96–$103 and the fund sale	Illustration only	—	(not a sourced figure)	—

1.5 Thumbnail

Headline **PRICE FELL / NO NEWS** · A falling coral price line and an empty "NEWS TODAY: NOTHING" card; label WHY STOCKS MOVE. Navy and gold brand palette, Arkad's Ledger logo row at the top. Files: thumbnails/v1-stock-price-no-news.jpg (161 KB, upload this) and .png master, 1080×1920, centred with equal side margins (measured difference ≤ 1 px) inside the safe zone x 100–980, y 420–1340.

5. Video 2: Where Your Lunch Dollar Really Goes

Field	Detail
Slot	2 · Everyday lunch topic (verified numbers) · **12:00 PM ET** · **Sun 11 Oct, 10:30 PM MMT** · 16:00 UTC
Pillar / format / series	P3 Everyday Economics & Pricing Psychology · F3 The Receipt · *What You're Really Paying For · Ep. 1*
Final length	**82.9 s** (202 words; narration 0.4–79.6 s, then the end card)
Video file	videos/v2-lunch-dollar.mp4
Thumbnail	thumbnails/v2-lunch-dollar.jpg · "ONLY 7¢ REACHES A FARM"
Visual plan	Burger and $1 bar with a 7¢ farm slice from frame 0; USDA Food Dollar title and FARM → FACTORY → TRUCK → RESTAURANT → YOU chain; restaurant 7.1¢ vs grocery 18.5¢ bars; receipt of the restaurant dollar by industry (processing 7.9¢, transport+wholesale 5.2¢, energy 3.1¢, finance & insurance 5.2¢, food service 65.8¢, other 12.8¢); NOT MOSTLY PROFIT stamp; primary-factor bar 59¢ salaries / 29¢ property income / taxes 6.9¢ / imports 4.6¢; payoff with 7¢ vs 93¢ bracket over the chain.
QA notes	voice_qa RUSH flag in the first take fixed by rephrasing one line and regenerating; final take has no flags · −16.3 LUFS, peak −2.0 dBFS, LRA 3.2 · frames reviewed: receipt title/65.8¢ overflow fixed, NOT MOSTLY PROFIT stamp held longer, blank start of the setup beat fixed (chain row now appears at once) and re-rendered · ASR 97.5% (number formatting; "That's more" dropped by the recogniser but confirmed present on a clip check).

2.1 Narration script with timestamps

Beat	Time	Narration (exact voice text)	Words
hook	0:00.4–0:05.2	When you buy lunch at a restaurant, only about seven cents of each dollar reaches the farm.	17
setup	0:06.2–0:19.3	That's from the US Department of Agriculture's Food Dollar, which follows every dollar Americans spend on food back through the supply chain. Its latest figures cover the year twenty twenty-four. So where do the other ninety-three cents go?	38
dev1	0:20.4–0:29.4	First, a comparison. Buy your food at a grocery store instead, and the farm share is about eighteen and a half cents. That's more than twice as much.	28
dev2	0:30.4–0:42.8	Now split the restaurant dollar by industry. Food processors add about eight cents. Trucks, warehouses and wholesalers, about five. Energy, about three. Banks and insurers, about five.	27
dev3	0:43.8–0:50.5	And the biggest line, by far, is the restaurant business itself: about sixty-six cents of every dollar.	17
reveal	0:51.5–1:12.6	But that money isn't mostly profit. Split the same dollar by what it pays for, and about fifty-nine cents goes to salaries and benefits, for cooks, servers, drivers and everyone else along the chain. About twenty-nine cents is property income: the return to whoever owns the buildings, the equipment and the land, profits included.	54
payoff	1:13.6–1:19.6	The farm grows the food. But most of your lunch money pays for everything that happens after it leaves the farm.	21

2.2 Scene-by-scene animation prompts

Scene	Time	Animation prompt
1 · hook	0:00.4–0:05.2	Frame 0: a burger on a plate; below it a $1 bar where only a thin gold 7¢ slice glows and the label REACHES THE FARM pops in.

Scene	Time	Animation prompt
2 · setup	0:06.2–0:19.3	Title card "THE FOOD DOLLAR" (US Department of Agriculture); a five-icon supply chain draws left to right; chip "2024 DATA · RELEASED MARCH 2026"; question "WHERE DO THE OTHER 93¢ GO?".
3 · dev1	0:20.4–0:29.4	Two vertical bars rise: RESTAURANT 7.1¢ and GROCERY STORE 18.5¢; chip "MORE THAN 2× THE FARM SHARE".
4 · dev2	0:30.4–0:42.8	A paper receipt unrolls titled "$1 OF RESTAURANT FOOD, BY INDUSTRY"; lines print one by one: processing, trucks/warehouses/wholesale, energy, banks & insurers.
5 · dev3	0:43.8–0:50.5	The receipt highlights FOOD SERVICE (THE RESTAURANT) and a large 65.8¢ stamps in; a faint "OTHER: FARMS, RETAIL, ADS, LEGAL 12.8¢" line follows.
6 · reveal	0:51.5–1:12.6	A coral NOT MOSTLY PROFIT stamp; then the same dollar re-splits into a bar: 59¢ salaries & benefits (cook, server, driver figures appear) and 29¢ property income with BUILDINGS / EQUIPMENT / LAND chips and "PROFITS INCLUDED".
7 · payoff	1:13.6–1:19.6	The supply chain returns; a bracket marks 7¢ at the farm and 93¢ over everything after it; closing line EVERYTHING AFTER THE FARM.
End card	1:19.6–1:22.9	Arkad's Ledger logo and wordmark on navy with a soft gold glow; sound-out.

2.3 Platform metadata

Platform	Text
YouTube Shorts	**Title:** Where Does Your Lunch Money Go? Only About 7¢ Reaches the Farm (62 chars). **Description:** When Americans buy food at a restaurant, only about 7 cents of each dollar reaches the farm. At the grocery store, the farm share is about 18.5 cents. We follow the restaurant dollar through the USDA's Food Dollar Series (2024 data): food processing about 8¢, trucks, warehouses and wholesale about 5¢, energy about 3¢, banks and insurers about 5¢, and the restaurant business itself about 66¢. Split by what the money pays for, about 59¢ goes to salaries and benefits and about 29¢ is property income, the return to whoever owns the buildings, equipment and land, profits included. ¶ Source: USDA Economic Research Service, Food Dollar Series (2024 data, released March 2026): https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/food-dollar-series/ · Glossary: https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/food-dollar-series/glossary ¶ Educational content, not financial advice. **Hashtags:** #economics #food #money
TikTok	**Caption:** Of every $1 you spend on a restaurant lunch, only about 7¢ reaches the farm 🍔 So where do the other 93¢ go? USDA Food Dollar data, 2024. Educational content, not financial advice. (Sources pinned) #economics #foodtok #learnontiktok #moneytok #restaurants · **Pinned comment:** Source: USDA Economic Research Service, Food Dollar Series, 2024 data (released March 2026), food away from home. Educational content, not financial advice.
Facebook Reels	**Caption:** Your lunch costs $1. How much of it does the farmer get? About 7 cents, according to the US Department of Agriculture. Here's where the rest goes, from food processing and trucking to energy, banks and the restaurant itself, and why most of it is wages, not profit. Educational content, not financial advice. (Source in the first comment.) #economics #food · **First comment:** Source: USDA ERS Food Dollar Series (2024 data, released March 2026): https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/food-dollar-series/

2.4 Verified sources (every figure used)

Figure / claim	What it measures	Date	Source	Link
Farm share of the food dollar: 7.1¢ food away from home, 18.5¢ food at home (11.8¢ overall); "about 7 cents" / "about 18½ cents"	US food dollar, marketing bill	2024 data, released 10 Mar 2026	USDA ERS Food Dollar Series	https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/food-dollar-series/

Figure / claim	What it measures	Date	Source	Link
Food away from home, industry group shares: food services 65.8¢, processing 7.9¢, transportation 2.5¢ + wholesale 2.7¢, energy 3.1¢, finance & insurance 5.2¢; other (agriculture 5.9, retail 3.0, advertising 2.5, legal 1.4) = 12.8¢	Food-away-from-home dollar, industry bill	2024 data, released 10 Mar 2026	USDA ERS Food Dollar Series	https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/food-dollar-series/
Primary factors, food away from home: salaries & benefits 59.0¢, property income 29.4¢, output taxes 6.9¢, imported inputs 4.6¢; property income = return to owners of capital before depreciation and interest	Food-away-from-home dollar, primary factor bill	2024 data, released 10 Mar 2026	USDA ERS Food Dollar Series + glossary	https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/food-dollar-series/glossary

2.5 Thumbnail

Headline **ONLY 7¢ REACHES A FARM** · Burger on a plate above a $1 bar with a 7¢ gold farm slice and "93¢ EVERYTHING ELSE". Navy and gold brand palette, Arkad's Ledger logo row at the top. Files: thumbnails/v2-lunch-dollar.jpg (169 KB, upload this) and .png master, 1080×1920, centred with equal side margins (measured difference ≤ 1 px) inside the safe zone x 100–980, y 420–1340.

6. Video 3: How McDonald's Really Makes Its Money

Field	Detail
Slot	3 · How a well-known company makes money (reveal) · **4:00 PM ET** · **Mon 12 Oct, 2:30 AM MMT** · 20:00 UTC
Pillar / format / series	P8 Business Models & Corporate Economics · F14 One Number · *Follow the Money* · *Ep. 3*
Final length	**95.5 s** (229 words; narration 0.4–92.1 s, then the end card)
Video file	videos/v3-mcdonalds-landlord.mp4
Thumbnail	thumbnails/v3-mcdonalds-landlord.jpg · "McDONALD'S IS A LANDLORD"
Visual plan	$139.4B systemwide-sales bar vs $26.9B revenue ("LESS THAN 1/5") from frame 0; grid of restaurants with ≈95% FRANCHISED; annual-report card; step ledger: royalties $6.0B (coins flowing franchisee → McDonald's), own restaurants $9.7B sales with cost chips and a $1.4B margin, building-on-land "A TYPICAL FRANCHISE DEAL" with 56% land / 80% buildings rings; reveal ledger rent $10.4B > royalties $6.0B and > $9.7B food sales; ≈90% of restaurant margins ring; payoff burger on top of building and land.
QA notes	voice_qa: no flags · −16.1 LUFS, peak −2.0 dBFS, LRA 3.8 · frames reviewed: ledger spread down the frame, ~6 s near-blank start of step 3 fixed (building and land now appear at once), a label that overlapped the source tag removed, hook revenue bar timed to "booked" · ASR 96.9% (number formatting; "Franchise" dropped at a segment boundary, confirmed present on a clip check).

3.1 Narration script with timestamps

Beat	Time	Narration (exact voice text)	Words
hook	0:00.4–0:10.0	In twenty twenty-five, people spent about one hundred and thirty-nine billion dollars at McDonald's restaurants. McDonald's itself booked less than a fifth of that as revenue.	26
setup	0:11.0–0:25.6	That's not a mistake. About ninety-five percent of its forty-five thousand restaurants are run by franchisees, local owners who keep the sales. So how does McDonald's make its money? Let's follow it, step by step, through its annual report.	39
dev1	0:26.7–0:34.3	Step one: royalties. Franchisees pay McDonald's a percentage of their sales. That brought in about six billion dollars.	18
dev2	0:35.3–0:48.4	Step two: the restaurants McDonald's runs itself. They sold about nine point seven billion dollars of food. But after food, packaging, staff and rent, the margin left was only about one point four billion.	34
dev3	0:49.4–1:05.5	Step three is the quiet one. In a typical franchise deal, McDonald's owns or leases the land and the building, and the franchisee pays it rent. In its consolidated markets, it owns about fifty-six percent of the land, and eighty percent of the buildings.	44
reveal	1:06.5–1:15.9	Now the reveal. Rent brought in ten point four billion dollars. That's more than the royalties. And it's more than all the food sold in McDonald's own restaurants.	28
dev4	1:16.9–1:25.5	It's also the high-margin part. Franchise income, after the cost of those properties, made up about ninety percent of the company's restaurant margins.	23
payoff	1:26.5–1:32.1	So yes, McDonald's sells burgers. But much of its money comes from being the landlord underneath them.	17

3.2 Scene-by-scene animation prompts

Scene	Time	Animation prompt
1 · hook	0:00.4–0:10.0	Frame 0: a tall gold bar "$139.4B SPENT AT ITS RESTAURANTS · 2025"; a short white bar "$26.9B McDONALD'S REVENUE" pops beside it with "LESS THAN 1/5".
2 · setup	0:11.0–0:25.6	A grid of identical small restaurant icons fills in; most turn gold as "≈ 95% FRANCHISED" appears (footnote 45,356 restaurants · 100+ countries); then the question "SO HOW DOES IT MAKE MONEY?" and an annual-report card (2025 FORM 10-K) slides in.
3 · dev1	0:26.7–0:34.3	Ledger step 1 ROYALTIES: coins flow from a franchisee shop to a McDonald's HQ icon; bar fills to $6.0B.
4 · dev2	0:35.3–0:48.4	Step 2 its OWN RESTAURANTS: sales bar $9.7B, then cost chips (food, packaging, staff, rent) eat it down to a thin $1.4B margin.
5 · dev3	0:49.4–1:05.5	Step 3: "A TYPICAL FRANCHISE DEAL" – a building lands on a gold LAND slab; label OWNED OR LEASED BY McDONALD'S; rings fill to 56% OF THE LAND and 80% OF THE BUILDINGS.
6 · reveal	1:06.5–1:15.9	Reveal ledger: RENT FROM FRANCHISEES $10.4B grows past ROYALTIES $6.0B and FOOD SALES IN ITS OWN RESTAURANTS $9.7B.
7 · dev4	1:16.9–1:25.5	A ring fills to "≈ 90% FROM FRANCHISED RESTAURANTS" of restaurant margins ($13.9B vs $1.4B).
8 · payoff	1:26.5–1:32.1	A burger sits on top of a building, which sits on the gold LAND slab; closing line about being the landlord underneath.
End card	1:32.1–1:35.5	Arkad's Ledger logo and wordmark on navy with a soft gold glow; sound-out.

3.3 Platform metadata

Platform	Text
YouTube Shorts	**Title:** How McDonald's Really Makes Money: It's the Landlord (52 chars). **Description:** In 2025 people spent about $139 billion at McDonald's restaurants, yet McDonald's booked less than a fifth of that as revenue, because about 95% of its 45,000+ restaurants are run by franchisees. Following its annual report step by step: royalties brought in about $6.0 billion; its own restaurants sold about $9.7 billion of food but kept a margin of only about $1.4 billion; and rent from franchisees brought in $10.4 billion, more than the royalties and more than all the food sold in its own restaurants. Franchise income made up about 90% of its restaurant margins. ¶ Source: McDonald's Corporation, Form 10-K for 2025 (filed 24 Feb 2026, SEC EDGAR): https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/63908/000006390826000035/mcd-20251231.htm ¶ Educational content, not financial advice. Not affiliated with McDonald's. **Hashtags:** #economics #business #mcdonalds
TikTok	**Caption:** McDonald's sells burgers… but its biggest revenue line is rent 🏠 $10.4B from franchisees in 2025, per its annual report. Educational content, not financial advice. (Source pinned) #economics #business #learnontiktok #mcdonalds #moneytok · **Pinned comment:** Source: McDonald's 2025 Form 10-K (filed 24 Feb 2026, SEC EDGAR): rent $10.4B, royalties $6.0B, company-operated sales $9.7B, ~95% franchised. Not affiliated with McDonald's. Educational content, not financial advice.
Facebook Reels	**Caption:** Is McDonald's really a burger company? Follow the money through its 2025 annual report: royalties, its own restaurants, and the quiet third line, rent. That one brought in $10.4 billion, more than the royalties and more than all the food sold in its own restaurants. Educational content, not financial advice. (Source in the first comment.) #economics #business · **First comment:** Source: McDonald's 2025 Form 10-K, SEC EDGAR: https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/63908/000006390826000035/mcd-20251231.htm (Not affiliated with McDonald's.)

3.4 Verified sources (every figure used)

Figure / claim	What it measures	Date	Source	Link
Systemwide sales $139.4B; total revenues $26.885B (≈19%, "less than a fifth"); 45,356 restaurants, ≈95% franchised, 100+ countries	McDonald's, FY2025	10-K filed 24 Feb 2026	McDonald's Corp. Form 10-K (SEC EDGAR)	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/63908/000006390826000035/mcd-20251231.htm
Franchised revenues $16.548B: rent $10.442B, royalties $6.018B, initial fees $88M; company-operated sales $9.690B	McDonald's revenue lines, FY2025	10-K filed 24 Feb 2026	McDonald's Corp. Form 10-K	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/63908/000006390826000035/mcd-20251231.htm
Restaurant margins: franchised $13.930B vs company-operated $1.422B (franchised ≈ 90%); owns ≈56% of land and ≈80% of buildings in consolidated markets; franchise terms generally 20 years	McDonald's, FY2025	10-K filed 24 Feb 2026	McDonald's Corp. Form 10-K	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/63908/000006390826000035/mcd-20251231.htm

3.5 Thumbnail

Headline **McDONALD'S IS A LANDLORD** · Generic restaurant building on a gold LAND slab, burger in front, ivory tag "RENT $10.4B"; label HOW McDONALD'S MAKES MONEY (no logo). Navy and gold brand palette, Arkad's Ledger logo row at the top. Files: thumbnails/v3-mcdonalds-landlord.jpg (206 KB, upload this) and .png master, 1080×1920, centred with equal side margins (measured difference ≤ 1 px) inside the safe zone x 100–980, y 420–1340.

7. Video 4: 1929: The Crash Was Only Act One. Then Came the Bank Runs

Field	Detail
Slot	4 · Flagship: longest, story arc, CTA · **7:00 PM ET** · **Mon 12 Oct, 5:30 AM MMT** · 23:00 UTC
Pillar / format / series	P10 Crises, Bubbles & Economic History · F9 Timeline Rewind · *Collapse Files* · *No. 002*
Final length	**158.3 s** (390 words; narration 0.4–155.0 s, then the end card)
Video file	videos/v4-1929-bank-runs.mp4
Thumbnail	thumbnails/v4-1929-bank-runs.jpg · "1929: THE CRASH / WAS ONLY ACT 1"
Visual plan	Hook: zoomed 1928–33 Dow line crashing, then a bank with a queue (THE BANK RUNS); 1920s boom chart 63 → 381; margin card $100 of shares = $10 cash + $90 borrowed; Oct 28/29 calendar tiles −13% / −12% and mid-Nov ½; NY Fed reserves to banks; "fall 1930: recovery looked close"; Nashville collapse and queues spreading town to town; the trap (deposits bar mostly IN LOANS, thin CASH slice, crowd drains it); suspensions bars 1,350 / 2,293 / 1,453 / ≈4,000 and "1930–33 ≈ 9,000"; deflation loop with globe (gold standard); −89% bottom (41.22, Jul 1932) and back at the peak Nov 1954; Banking Act of 1933 doc + CREATES THE FDIC stamp; shield $2,500 from 1 Jan 1934 and "only 9 insured banks failed"; NO REASON TO RUN; today $250,000; CTA end card "FOLLOW FOR FILE NO. 003".
QA notes	Longest video of the day. voice_qa DRONE/LOW flags in the first take fixed by rephrasing the bank-cash line and regenerating; final 158.3 s take has no flags · −16.1 LUFS, peak −2.1 dBFS, LRA 3.4 · frames reviewed: hook chart zoomed to 1928–33, boom chart rescaled with a title card, globe moved beside the deflation loop, Nashville scene shows the bank from the first frame, Banking-Act document no longer overlaps the shield, then re-rendered. One sparse frame at about 72–74 s is the empty deposits bar filling in (intended) · ASR 96.5% (number formatting such as "nineteen" vs "1,900"; a word heard differently was confirmed correct on a clip check).

4.1 Narration script with timestamps

Beat	Time	Narration (exact voice text)	Words
hook	0:00.4–0:06.2	The stock market crash of nineteen twenty-nine wasn't the real disaster. What happened to the banks next was.	18
setup	0:07.3–0:19.3	Collapse Files, number two. In the nineteen twenties, the Dow Jones index rose about six-fold, from sixty-three in nineteen twenty-one to three hundred and eighty-one in September nineteen twenty-nine.	29
dev1	0:20.3–0:33.6	A lot of that buying ran on borrowed money. Buyers often put down about ten percent and borrowed the rest, using the shares as collateral. That works while prices rise. When they fall, borrowers can be forced to sell.	39
dev2	0:34.6–0:47.0	Then came October. On Black Monday, October twenty-eighth, the Dow fell nearly thirteen percent. The next day, nearly twelve percent more. By mid-November, it had lost almost half its value.	30
dev3	0:48.0–0:58.6	Here's the surprise. The New York Federal Reserve rushed reserves to the banks at the center of the storm, and they stayed open. By the fall of nineteen thirty, a recovery looked close.	33
turn	0:59.6–1:11.7	Then, in November nineteen thirty, a large financial company in Nashville collapsed, and its banks closed their doors. In town after town, depositors panicked and rushed to pull out their cash.	31
mech	1:12.7–1:26.9	That's the trap. A bank holds just a small fraction of its deposits as cash. Most of its money sits in loans, which can't be turned into cash overnight. If everyone asks at once, even a healthy bank can run out of cash.	43

Beat	Time	Narration (exact voice text)	Words
dev4	1:28.0–1:44.6	The panics came in waves. From nineteen thirty to nineteen thirty-three, about nine thousand US banks suspended operations. People hoarded cash, the money supply shrank, and prices fell. Through the gold standard, the deflation spread to other countries too.	39
dev5	1:45.6–1:54.6	The stock market hit bottom in July nineteen thirty-two, eighty-nine percent below its peak. It didn't get back to that peak until November nineteen fifty-four.	25
reveal	1:55.6–2:11.9	The fix went straight at the panic. In June nineteen thirty-three, a new law created the FDIC. From January nineteen thirty-four, bank deposits were insured, up to two thousand five hundred dollars. That year, only nine insured banks failed.	39
payoff	2:12.9–2:21.9	Deposit insurance didn't make bad loans disappear. It removed the reason to run. If your money is safe either way, nobody needs to be first in line.	27
cta	2:23.0–2:35.0	Today the standard limit is two hundred and fifty thousand dollars, and the FDIC says no one has lost a penny of insured deposits. Follow Arkad's Ledger for the next file on the systems behind your money.	37

4.2 Scene-by-scene animation prompts

Scene	Time	Animation prompt
1 · hook	0:00.4–0:06.2	Frame 0: a Dow line (labelled SHAPE SIMPLIFIED) spikes at 1929 and crashes; "THE CRASH / NOT THE REAL DISASTER", then a classical bank with a queue of depositors.
2 · setup	0:07.3–0:19.3	Series card "COLLAPSE FILES · NO. 002", then "THE 1920s BOOM": the Dow line climbs from a dot at 63 (Aug 1921) to 381 (Sep 1929); a ×6 badge.
3 · dev1	0:20.3–0:33.6	Margin card: "$100 OF SHARES" splits into "$10 YOUR CASH" and "$90 BORROWED"; chip THE SHARES ARE THE COLLATERAL; a down arrow then FORCED TO SELL.
4 · dev2	0:34.6–0:47.0	Calendar tiles flip: OCT 28 MON −13% (Black Monday), OCT 29 TUE −12%, then MID-NOV ½ "ALMOST HALF GONE".
5 · dev3	0:48.0–0:58.6	"HERE'S THE SURPRISE": coins flow from a NEW YORK FED building to small banks that stay lit; a gentle line labelled "FALL 1930: RECOVERY LOOKED CLOSE".
6 · turn	0:59.6–1:11.7	November 1930: a large building in "NASHVILLE, TENNESSEE" goes dark and its banks close; queues of depositors then appear at bank after bank across the frame; PANIC SPREADS.
7 · mech	1:12.7–1:26.9	"THE TRAP": a tall bar "A BANK'S DEPOSITS" – most labelled IN LOANS (can't be cashed overnight), a thin gold CASH slice (PROPORTIONS ILLUSTRATIVE); a crowd rushes in and drains the cash slice.
8 · dev4	1:28.0–1:44.6	Bars rise for US bank suspensions: 1930 1,350 · 1931 2,293 · 1932 1,453 · 1933 ≈4,000; chip "1930–33: ≈ 9,000 BANKS SUSPENDED". Then the deflation loop: PEOPLE HOARD CASH → MONEY SUPPLY SHRINKS → PRICES FALL; an arrow to a globe "VIA THE GOLD STANDARD → OTHER COUNTRIES".
9 · dev5	1:45.6–1:54.6	Long Dow chart: bottom dot 41.22 · JUL 1932 with −89%, then a dashed line back to the 1929 level in NOV 1954.
10 · reveal	1:55.6–2:11.9	"THE FIX": a document card "BANKING ACT OF 1933 · SIGNED 16 JUNE 1933" with a CREATES THE FDIC stamp; it becomes a shield with a check, "$2,500 INSURED · FROM 1 JANUARY 1934", and a panel "1934: ONLY 9 INSURED BANKS FAILED".
11 · payoff	2:12.9–2:21.9	The bank and the queue: the figures calmly disperse; "NO REASON TO RUN" and "NOBODY NEEDS TO BE FIRST IN LINE".

Scene	Time	Animation prompt
12 · cta	2:23.0–2:35.0	CTA: shield with "TODAY $250,000" (standard limit per depositor, per bank, per ownership category) and the FDIC "no one has lost a penny" line; end card "COLLAPSE FILES · FOLLOW FOR FILE NO. 003".
End card	2:35.0–2:38.3	Arkad's Ledger logo and wordmark on navy with a soft gold glow; sound-out.

4.3 Platform metadata

Platform	Text
YouTube Shorts	**Title:** The 1929 Crash Was Only Act One: How Bank Runs Made It a Depression (67 chars). **Description:** The stock market crash of 1929 wasn't the real disaster. The Dow rose from 63 (1921) to 381 (September 1929), much of it bought with borrowed money. It fell nearly 13% on Black Monday and nearly 12% the next day. The New York Fed kept the banks open and by fall 1930 recovery looked close. Then a large Nashville financial company collapsed, panic spread from town to town, and about 9,000 US banks suspended operations from 1930 to 1933. Cash hoarding shrank the money supply, prices fell, and the gold standard spread deflation abroad. The Dow bottomed in July 1932, 89% below its peak, and only regained it in November 1954. The fix: the Banking Act of 1933 created the FDIC, deposit insurance began 1 January 1934 ($2,500), and that year only nine insured banks failed. Today's standard limit is $250,000. ¶ Sources: Federal Reserve History, "Stock Market Crash of 1929": https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/stock-market-crash-of-1929 · "Banking Panics of 1930-31": https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/banking-panics-1930-31 · "Banking Act of 1933 (Glass-Steagall)": https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/glass-steagall-act · FDIC, "A Brief History of Deposit Insurance": https://www.fdic.gov/bank/historical/brief/brhist.pdf · FDIC 90 years: https://www.fdic.gov/90years ¶ Educational content, not financial advice. The chart shape in the video is simplified between the sourced points. **Hashtags:** #economics #history #banking
TikTok	**Caption:** The 1929 crash wasn't the real disaster. The bank runs were 🏦 How ~9,000 US banks failed, and the fix that ended the panics. Collapse Files No. 002. Educational content, not financial advice. (Sources pinned) #economics #history #learnontiktok #greatdepression #moneytok · **Pinned comment:** Sources: Federal Reserve History (Stock Market Crash of 1929; Banking Panics of 1930-31; Banking Act of 1933); FDIC, A Brief History of Deposit Insurance; FDIC 90 years. Chart shape simplified between sourced points. Educational content, not financial advice.
Facebook Reels	**Caption:** Most people remember the stock market crash of 1929. But the real damage came next, when depositors rushed their banks and about 9,000 US banks suspended operations between 1930 and 1933. Here's how a crash became a bank panic, why even healthy banks could run out of cash, and the 1933 fix that took away the reason to run. Educational content, not financial advice. (Sources in the first comment.) #economics #history · **First comment:** Sources: https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/stock-market-crash-of-1929 · https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/banking-panics-1930-31 · https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/glass-steagall-act · https://www.fdic.gov/bank/historical/brief/brhist.pdf · https://www.fdic.gov/90years

4.4 Verified sources (every figure used)

Figure / claim	What it measures	Date	Source	Link
Dow 63 (Aug 1921) → 381 (Sep 1929, close 381.17 on 3 Sep); margin buyers typically put down 10%; Black Monday (28 Oct) nearly −13%, Black Tuesday nearly −12%; almost half lost by mid-November; NY Fed supplied reserves, banks stayed open; recovery appeared	Dow Jones Industrial Average, 1921–1954	essay	Federal Reserve History, "Stock Market Crash of 1929"	https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/stock-market-crash-of-1929

Figure / claim	What it measures	Date	Source	Link
imminent by fall 1930; low 41.22 on 8 Jul 1932, 89% below peak; peak regained 23 Nov 1954				
Caldwell and Company (Nashville) collapsed Nov 1930; panic spread town to town; hoarding shrank the money supply; deflation; gold standard transmitted it to other nations	Banking panics 1930–31	essay	Federal Reserve History, "Banking Panics of 1930–31"	https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/banking-panics-1930-31
Bank suspensions 1,350 (1930), 2,293 (1931), 1,453 (1932), ≈4,000 (1933); insurance effective 1 Jan 1934 at $2,500; nine insured banks failed in 1934	US banks	FDIC history	FDIC, "A Brief History of Deposit Insurance"	https://www.fdic.gov/bank/historical/brief/brhist.pdf
≈9,000 banks suspended 1930–33; no depositor has lost a penny of insured deposits	US banks / FDIC	FDIC 90-year timeline	FDIC	https://www.fdic.gov/90years
Banking Act of 1933 signed 16 June 1933, created the FDIC; standard limit now $250,000	US law	essay	Federal Reserve History, "Banking Act of 1933 (Glass-Steagall)"	https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/glass-steagall-act
Chart shape between sourced points; deposits/cash proportions	Illustration only	—	(not a sourced figure)	—

4.5 Thumbnail

Headline **1929: THE CRASH / WAS ONLY ACT 1** · Coral crash line labelled THE CRASH above a gold bank with queues of depositors; label THEN THE BANK RUNS. Navy and gold brand palette, Arkad's Ledger logo row at the top. Files: thumbnails/v4-1929-bank-runs.jpg (203 KB, upload this) and .png master, 1080×1920, centred with equal side margins (measured difference ≤ 1 px) inside the safe zone x 100–980, y 420–1340.

8. Video 5: Why Early Mortgage Payments Are Mostly Interest

Field	Detail
Slot	5 · Calm formula · **9:30 PM ET** · **Mon 12 Oct, 8:00 AM MMT** · 01:30 (12 Oct) UTC
Pillar / format / series	P4 Debt, Credit & Interest · F5 Build-a-Formula · *Ledger Formulas · Ep. 3*
Final length	**85.6 s** (219 words; narration 0.4–82.2 s, then the end card)
Video file	videos/v5-mortgage-interest.mp4
Thumbnail	thumbnails/v5-mortgage-interest.jpg · "PAYMENT 1: 83% INTEREST"
Visual plan	House with a payment bar 83% interest from frame 0; formula built term by term (THIS MONTH'S INTEREST = BALANCE YOU OWE × YEARLY RATE ÷ 12); EXAMPLE loan card $300,000 · 6% · 30 years → $1,798.65; month 1 working ($1,500 interest / $298.65 to loan); month 1 vs month 2 bars ($1,498.51 / $300.14, ↓$1.49 / ↑$1.49); chart of interest vs principal over 360 months crossing at month 223 (year 18.6); total interest $347,515 vs $300,000 borrowed; formula with BALANCE highlighted while the bar sweeps from payment 1 to 360; AMORTIZATION.
QA notes	voice_qa LOW flag in the first take fixed by rephrasing one line; final take has no flags · −15.9 LUFS, peak −2.1 dBFS, LRA 3.1 · frames reviewed: example-loan card now appears with "THE EXAMPLE LOAN" from the start of the beat, total-interest bar grows from "Over thirty years", payoff bar shown from the start of the beat; re-rendered · ASR 97.7% (only "$" formatting) · amortization numbers asserted in code (payment $1,798.65, crossover month 223, total interest $347,514.57).

5.1 Narration script with timestamps

Beat	Time	Narration (exact voice text)	Words
hook	0:00.4–0:06.2	On a thirty-year mortgage, the first payment is mostly interest. One short formula shows why.	15
setup	0:07.2–0:16.6	Here it is. This month's interest equals the balance you still owe, times the yearly rate, divided by twelve. The rest of your payment pays down the loan.	28
dev1	0:17.6–0:29.2	Let's run an example. Three hundred thousand dollars, borrowed at six percent a year, over thirty years. The fixed monthly payment works out to about one thousand seven hundred and ninety-nine dollars.	32
dev2	0:30.2–0:42.5	Month one. Three hundred thousand, times six percent, divided by twelve, is one thousand five hundred dollars of interest. That leaves only about two hundred and ninety-nine dollars to reduce the debt.	32
dev3	0:43.5–0:53.9	Month two. The balance is a little lower, so the interest is a little lower, and a little more goes to the loan. The payment itself never changes, but the split inside it does.	34
reveal	0:54.9–1:10.4	In this example, it takes until month two hundred and twenty-three, more than eighteen years in, before most of the payment goes to the loan. Over thirty years, the interest adds up to about three hundred and forty-eight thousand dollars. That's more than the amount borrowed.	46
payoff	1:11.5–1:22.2	Interest is charged on what you still owe. So when you owe the most, interest takes the biggest share. That's amortization: the same payment, slowly shifting from the lender's side to yours.	32

5.2 Scene-by-scene animation prompts

Scene	Time	Animation prompt
1 · hook	0:00.4–0:06.2	Frame 0: a simple house; under it PAYMENT 1 OF 360 and a bar that is mostly coral (INTEREST 83%) with a small gold end (LOAN 17%); EXAMPLE tag and "ONE FORMULA".
2 · setup	0:07.2–0:16.6	Panel "THE FORMULA" builds line by line: THIS MONTH'S INTEREST = BALANCE YOU OWE × YEARLY RATE ÷ 12; a small bar shows INTEREST + PAYS DOWN THE LOAN = the payment.
3 · dev1	0:17.6–0:29.2	Formula chip pinned at the top; EXAMPLE card fills: BORROWED $300,000 · RATE 6% A YEAR · TERM 30 YEARS → FIXED MONTHLY PAYMENT $1,798.65.
4 · dev2	0:30.2–0:42.5	"MONTH 1": $300,000 × 6% ÷ 12 = $1,500 INTEREST; payment bar splits $1,500 interest / $298.65 to loan.
5 · dev3	0:43.5–0:53.9	"MONTH 1 → MONTH 2": two stacked bars with balances $300,000 and $299,701.35; interest $1,498.51 (↓$1.49), loan $300.14 (↑$1.49); chip SAME $1,798.65 EVERY MONTH.
6 · reveal	0:54.9–1:10.4	Line chart over 30 years: coral interest line falls, gold principal line rises; they cross at a glowing dot "MONTH 223 · YEAR 18.6"; then "OVER 30 YEARS": TOTAL INTEREST $347,515 bar beats AMOUNT BORROWED $300,000.
7 · payoff	1:11.5–1:22.2	Formula panel with BALANCE glowing; the payment bar sweeps from PAYMENT 1 to PAYMENT 360 as coral (LENDER'S SIDE) shrinks and gold (YOURS) grows; word AMORTIZATION lands.
End card	1:22.2–1:25.6	Arkad's Ledger logo and wordmark on navy with a soft gold glow; sound-out.

5.3 Platform metadata

Platform	Text
YouTube Shorts	**Title:** Why Is My First Mortgage Payment Mostly Interest? One Formula Explains It (73 chars). **Description:** Monthly interest = balance you still owe × yearly rate ÷ 12. The rest of the payment pays down the loan. Worked example (illustrative): $300,000 at 6% a year over 30 years gives a fixed payment of about $1,798.65. In month one, interest is $1,500 and only $298.65 reduces the debt. Each month the balance falls a little, so interest falls a little and more goes to the loan. In this example, principal first exceeds interest in month 223 (about 18.6 years in), and total interest over 30 years is about $347,515, more than the amount borrowed. That gradual shift is amortization. ¶ Source: Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, "How does paying down a mortgage work?": https://www.consumerfinance.gov/ask-cfpb/how-does-paying-down-a-mortgage-work-en-1943/ (example loan computed with the standard amortization formula) ¶ Educational content, not financial advice. The loan numbers are an illustrative example. **Hashtags:** #economics #mortgage #money
TikTok	**Caption:** Why is your first mortgage payment mostly interest? One formula: interest = balance × rate ÷ 12 🏠 Example loan, not a quote. Educational content, not financial advice. (Source pinned) #economics #mortgage #learnontiktok #moneytok #math · **Pinned comment:** Source: CFPB, "How does paying down a mortgage work?" Example: $300,000 at 6% over 30 years (illustrative, standard amortization formula). Educational content, not financial advice.
Facebook Reels	**Caption:** On a 30-year mortgage, why does so little of the first payment reduce the loan? It comes down to one short formula: this month's interest = the balance you still owe × the yearly rate ÷ 12. Here's one worked example, month by month. Educational content, not financial advice. (Source in the first comment.) #economics #mortgage · **First comment:** Source: CFPB, How does paying down a mortgage work? https://www.consumerfinance.gov/ask-cfpb/how-does-paying-down-a-mortgage-work-en-1943/ (Loan numbers in the video are an illustrative example.)

5.4 Verified sources (every figure used)

Figure / claim	What it measures	Date	Source	Link
Each payment covers interest first; interest is based on the remaining balance, so early payments are mostly interest and later payments mostly principal (amortization)	How mortgage payments work	last reviewed 28 May 2024	Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, "How does paying down a mortgage work?"	https://www.consumerfinance.gov/ask-cfpb/how-does-paying-down-a-mortgage-work-en-1943/
$300,000 at 6% for 30 years: payment $1,798.65; month 1 $1,500 / $298.65; month 2 $1,498.51 / $300.14; principal first exceeds interest in month 223 (18.6 yrs); total interest $347,514.57	Illustration only (standard amortization formula, computed and asserted in the render script)	—	(not a sourced figure)	—

5.5 Thumbnail

Headline **PAYMENT 1: 83% INTEREST** · Formula card INTEREST = BALANCE × RATE ÷ 12 above a house and a payment bar that is 83% coral INTEREST; "EXAMPLE: $300K · 6% · 30 YRS". Navy and gold brand palette, Arkad's Ledger logo row at the top. Files: thumbnails/v5-mortgage-interest.jpg (186 KB, upload this) and .png master, 1080×1920, centred with equal side margins (measured difference ≤ 1 px) inside the safe zone x 100–980, y 420–1340.

9. Verification status & open items

Verified on 10 Oct 2026 against primary sources: Cutler, Poterba & Summers (NBER w2538) and Investor.gov (V1); USDA ERS Food Dollar Series, 2024 data released 10 Mar 2026 (V2); McDonald's 2025 Form 10-K on SEC EDGAR (V3); Federal Reserve History essays and FDIC histories (V4); CFPB (V5). Example numbers are tagged EXAMPLE on screen and the V5 loan arithmetic is computed and asserted in the render script.

Notes / open items:

- **V2 consistency:** the hook's 7¢ farm share comes from the USDA marketing bill (food away from home, 7.1¢); the receipt uses the USDA industry bill, where farms (agriculture 5.9¢) sit inside the OTHER line (12.8¢). Both are real USDA series; they are not mixed in one chart.
- **V4 chart:** the Dow line passes through the sourced points (63, 381, the October drops, 41.22, the 1954 recovery) and is labelled SHAPE SIMPLIFIED between them. "Nine insured banks failed in 1934" counts insured banks only (the FDIC table also lists 52 uninsured).
- **V4 length:** 158.3 s, over the ~150 s flagship preference but under the 180 s hard limit.
- **Rotation:** P8 fills slot 3 for the third day running because of the owner's slot-3 brief. Four videos fall in the preferred 65–100 s band (V1 93.2 s, V2 82.9 s, V3 95.5 s, V5 85.6 s).
- **ASR results (final MP4s):** V1 99.6%, V2 97.5%, V3 96.9%, V4 96.5%, V5 97.7% word match. Every difference is number formatting ("$1,500" vs "one thousand five hundred dollars") or a word dropped at a recogniser segment boundary; the dropped words were re-checked on short clips and are clearly present ("That's more than twice as much", "Franchise income").